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AFP

■ Security personnel stand beside charred vehicles at the blast site after an explosion near the Red Fort in the old quarters of Delhi yesterday.

Delhi car blast kills 13; India goes on high alert

24 HURT IN POWERFUL EXPLOSION NEAR METRO STATION

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

At least 13 people were killed and 24 injured yesterday evening when a powerful explosion ripped through a car near the Red Fort Metro Station, one of the most crowded areas in the Indian capital.

The blast occurred around 7pm near Gate No. 1 of the metro station, sending flames and debris across the street packed with commuters and tourists. The explosion ignited several parked vehicles and left the area strewn with mangled metal and charred bodies. It occurred barely 50 kilometres from Faridabad, where authorities recovered 2,900 kilograms of explosives in two raids on Sunday and yesterday, raising concerns of a possible connection.

Visuals broadcast on Indian television showed a Swift Dzire car engulfed in flames, a nearby van with its doors blown off and glass scattered across the road. "It was a very powerful explosion," sources in Delhi

● **The explosion occurred barely 50 kilometres from Faridabad, where authorities recovered 2,900 kilograms of explosives in two raids, raising concerns of a possible connection.**

Police told local media. A massive emergency response was launched. Seven fire tenders and around 20 fire engines rushed to the site, according to Deputy Chief Fire Officer A.K. Malik, who said the blaze was brought under control by 7:30pm.

Doctors at Lok Nayak Jai Prakash Narayan Hospital confirmed that eight victims were declared dead on arrival, while several others were undergoing treatment for burns and blast injuries. "Three are critical; one is in stable condition," the hospital's medical superintendent told ANI.

The Delhi Police's Special Cell and forensic teams have cordoned off the area and

launched an investigation to determine the cause of the explosion. "We are probing all angles; it is too early to comment," said police spokesperson Sanjay Tyagi, adding that the National Security Guard (NSG) and CRPF officers were assisting.

Scenes of panic

Witnesses described scenes of panic. "I saw a huge fireball from my terrace. The blast shook the windows," said a resident. An auto-rickshaw driver, Zeeshan, who was injured, told reporters: "The car in front of me exploded. I don't know if it was a bomb or something else, but it was a Swift Dzire."

Another shopkeeper said he "never heard such a loud explosion" and that body parts were strewn across the road. "When we saw someone's hand lying on the street, everyone froze," he told PTL.

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has issued a high alert across the country — including airports, Delhi Metro, heritage sites, government buildings and other key installations under its security cover.

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Finding a parking in Dubai to be faster and easier soon

Emirate plans real-time parking visibility

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Dubai drivers will be able to see live and real-time parking availability from 2026, as Parkin accelerates one of its most ambitious technology upgrades to date.

The company, which manages over 250,000 parking spaces across the emirate, is rolling out a multi-stage programme that will place cameras, sensors, and digital tools across multi-storey, off-street, and high-demand on-street locations.

Eng Mohammad Al Ali,

CEO of Parkin, said the live availability system is already under development and will begin with multi-storey and off-street car parks next year.

He added that 500 new cameras are being installed as part of the first phase, focused on event zones around the Dubai World Trade Centre and other high-pressure areas. Once the trials are completed, Parkin will expand the network in several phases through 2026. The move is part of a wider strategy to ease congestion during large events and seasonal peaks.

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UAE 'probably won't join Gaza stabilisation force'

Gargash reaffirms country's support for political efforts towards peace in Gaza

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

Dr Anwar Gargash, diplomatic adviser to the UAE President, said yesterday that the UAE is not planning to join the international stabilisation force for Gaza because it lacks a clear framework.

"The UAE does not yet see a clear framework for the stability force, and under such circumstances, it will probably not participate in such a force," Gargash told the Abu Dhabi Strategic Debate forum.

The US-coordinated international force has been expected to include troops from Egypt, Qatar, and Turkey.

Last week, US President Donald Trump said he expected the force to be deployed in Gaza "very soon," as a fragile ceasefire holds following two years of war.

Full international legitimacy

The president's projection came as the United Nations Security Council prepares to start negotiations to authorise a two-year mandate for a transitional governance body and the stabilisation force, which is intended to protect civilians, secure border areas, and train Palestinian police. UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres told media last week that any stabilisation force must have "full international legitimacy" to support Palestin-



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Dr Anwar Gargash

| Diplomatic adviser to the UAE President

ians in Gaza. According to Reuters, the UN resolution would permit a stabilisation force of 20,000 troops to "use all necessary measures" to carry out its mandate — meaning it will be authorised to deploy force.

At the forum, Gargash reaffirmed the UAE's continued support for political efforts toward peace. "But it will support all political efforts aimed at peace and will remain at the forefront of countries providing humanitarian aid," he said.

Gargash noted that throughout the war in Gaza, the UAE has provided assistance exceeding \$2.57 billion.

At the Reuters NEXT Gulf Summit last month, Gargash reiterated the UAE's support for a two-state solution as part of an Arab and international vision that "provides Israel with security, but also Palestinians with a viable state."

He said the UAE has played a crucial humanitarian role in Gaza, providing billions of dollars in aid and 100,000 tonnes of food and medical supplies.

— With inputs from AFP

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